

THE GRAMDAN MOVEMENT

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THE GRAMDAN MOVEMENT

The Latest Phase Of Bhoodan

The renunciation of private property in land on a mass scale through Gramdans is the latest and most significant development of the Bhoodan movement that is attracting widespread attention. Though the Gramdan movement began as far back as 1952 with the rather unexpected and spontaneous action of the villagers of Mangroth in U. P., it was only during and after Vinobaji's foot-march through Orissa, that the movement assumed mass proportions. We propose to briefly outline the genesis, development and future outlook of the movement in the following pages, with special reference to Orissa.

The first Gramdan in Orissa was obtained in Manpur, in the Cuttack district on 30th January 1953 and shortly afterwards the movement caught on in the Koraput district where 26 Gramdans were received by the time Vinobaji entered Orissa on the 26th January 1955. A few Gramdans had also been received in the districts of Balasore, Mayurbhanj, Ganjam and Sambalpur, but with Vinobaji's progress southwards, naturally, more attention was centred on Ganjam and Koraput, where Bhoodan workers from all over the province concentrated their efforts with the result that by the time Vinobaji left Orissa, the total number for the province reached 812 with 606 to the credit of Koraput alone. Since then the movement has continued to progress and the number of Gramdans has almost doubled, while the movement has spread to ten out of the thirteen districts in the province. We give below a district-wise breakup of the figures.

Total Gramdans in Orissa

As on 15th, December, 1956

1. Koraput	...	1226
2. Balasore	...	185
3. Mayurbhanj	...	62
4. Ganjam	...	54
5. Sambalpur	...	12
6. Sundergarh	...	15
7. Keonjhar	...	2
8. Dhenkanal	...	1
9. Puri	...	17
10. Cuttack	...	1
Total		1575

The average population of a village in Orissa is a little more than three hundred. The villages received in Gramdan are generally the smaller ones, with an average population of one hundred and twenty. It is but natural that villages with a homogenous population of peasants, labourers and artisans habituated to physical labour should be the first to offer themselves in Gramdan. The larger villages with high-caste families of sub-letting land-owners, money lenders etc are at present holding back. Kharka in Koraput district is the largest Gramdan village with a population of 900 while the smallest hamlet has a population of eight. The total population of all the villages is estimated at two lakhs.

Most of the villages in the Koraput district and elsewhere are Adivasi in character, each village being generally inhabited by a single tribe. This circumstance is doubtless one of the major predisposing factors, but there is a considerable number of villages with non-Adivasi and mixed populations. The number of such villages in Koraput exceeds 150 and is 80 in the Balasore district. All the villages in Sambalpur are non-Adivasi in character.

The movement has not been confined to Orissa but has simultaneously continued to spread in the other states also, so that there are already Gramdans in eleven of the states. (See Map) It is showing signs of growing into a mighty movement in Tamilnad where Vinobaji is at present touring. A further development in Tamilnad is Grama Sankalpa, by which the villagers take a four-fold pledge :—

1. To give land to all the landless,
2. To eradicate untouchability and casteism,
3. To take to Khadi and Village Industries within a stipulated period, and
4. To have basic education in the village.

Twenty six villages have already taken the pledge and the idea is spreading. This is in effect a combined pledge of Gramdan and subsequent reconstruction.

The Psychological Atmosphere.

Gramdan on such a vast scale opens up the most exhilarating possibilities of social reconstruction and economic upliftment, of building up a new social order based on equality and co-operation. The voluntary renunciation of private property and eager acceptance of the new way of life of 'getting along together', unleashes undreamt of reservoirs of constructive social energy, repressed under the deadweight of an outmoded, exploitive and competitive social system. It is coming to be more and more generally recognised that popular enthusiasm and participation is an essential ingredient for the success of economic planning. Some of the spectacular results achieved in New China in recent years have been attributed, no doubt rightly, to the above causes. In any society this energy is generated on a considerable scale only when the underdogs, the underprivileged classes, get a feeling that they are getting a fair deal, that they are real participants in the rebuilding of a new order, not merely so many 'hands' employed in renovating the old.

This has happened to a certain extent after the communist revolution in China, but while the latter has succeeded in liberating the energies of the under privileged masses, it has also, in the process of doing so, generated conflict and hostility on a considerable scale, the repercussions of which are being felt throughout the world to-day. It has brought into being forces that have complicated the problem of world peace.

Adherents of the democratic process have set their faces strongly against the fundamentally violent methods adopted in China and elsewhere, and it had seemed that planned progress in a democracy is bound to be a slow process and cannot hope to show the spectacular results achieved in the communist countries. This has posed a fine problem for the underdeveloped and newly independent countries of the world. For them rapid economic progress is a sine qua non of their continued existence and yet, how far can they avoid being entangled in the methods of totalitarian regimentation, in their eager efforts to force the pace ?

Here the Gramdan movement provides an alternative. Here is a movement that has succeeded in at least subduing if not eliminating the individualistic traits in the peasantry, has put hope into the underdog, and yet, while liberating the repressed creative energies, has not generated the least amount of friction and ill-will having based itself on the purely peaceful methods of persuasion.

Here the reader may pertinently ask, to what extent is the success of the movement due to the real psychological changes wrought in the minds of the people and how far due to the circumstances peculiar to the areas ? Is it not a fact that the movement has made considerable headway only among the backward Adivasis, and has demonstrably failed to catch on in the more advanced districts ? Is not land plentiful and cheap in the sparsely populated district of Koraput ? Have not the Adivasis very little attachment for land, and are in the habit of shifting cultivation ?

It is a fact that the movement has had more success among the Adivasis, who have a strong tradition of social cohesiveness. But this merely underlines the fact that even the backward classes in India have some valuable social traits highly useful for a new Sarvodaya or socialist order and the Gramdan movement is helping to preserve and canalise them. As a matter of fact, as we have noted earlier, quite a large number of villages with mixed and non-Adivasi populations have opted for Gramdan.

In this context it is significant that the movement seems to have caught on in the non-Adivasi and relatively more advanced state of Tamilnad, which has upto now more than forty Gramdans to its credit.

Another predisposing factor in Koraput was the awakened consciousness of the people due to their participation in the national freedom struggle since the early thirties and the subsequent intensive constructive activities carried on there by a band of determined and selfless workers. Thus the psychological ground was being slowly prepared for more than two decades. In a way the psychological preparation has been going on in India since centuries, where numerous saints and social reformers have preached against untrammelled individualism and Vinobaji's movement is a flowering of that long historical process, a culmination.

Several erroneous ideas are prevalent about the land situation in Koraput. An analysis of the statistics of 472 villages where land has been re-distributed, shows that the average of cultivated and cultivable waste land per capita is only 1.33 acres. Taking into consideration the hilly nature of the area, this is not much. The people are not less attached to land than peasants in any other part of the world, and are as ready to fight and murder in disputes concerning land. Most of them are peasants with a settled life. One of the obvious reasons for their taking to Podu or shifting cultivation is that the money lenders have filched their good lands in the valleys and have thus forced them to go higher and higher up on the hill-sides.

It is difficult to assess the actual depth of understanding in each and every village in a vast movement that has reached mass proportions. It is but natural that there should be all the gradations from the highest levels of understanding and ideological maturity to the lowest levels of herd mentality, and there have been a few dozens of regressions also. It is remarkable that the percentage of backsliders has been so small. An estimate of the degree of psychological change may however be formed from the results of land redistribution.

Land Redistribution

Redistribution work was carried on during the winter and summer of 1955-56 and with one mighty effort, the work in 602 out of 850 villages donated by then was completed. The villagers themselves fixed the principles of redistribution, such as, which family was to get how much land per capita etc and the Bhoodan workers helped them with advice and in technical matters. The ideal, of course, was a thoroughly egalitarian distribution with shares in all types of land, to each family according to the number of its members. A good 20% of the villages strictly adhered to this ideal. But the majority of them preferred to give some extra land to the bigger land owners, amounting from one and a half to three times the per capita average in the villages. In a minority of villages, they agreed to give even more than this to persuade a few recalcitrant big owners to join them, while as mentioned earlier, here were about 20 to 30 villages which went back on their pledge and refused to have any redistribution. There were also many cases in which former big owners refused to accept the bigger than the average shares so graciously offered to them by their fellow villagers.

To cite a few instances, Shri Mudi Nayak of Tala agreed to accept only ten acres in lieu of his former 60 acres. He has a family of four and this ten acres is near by $2\frac{1}{2}$ times the average in the village. Shri Ghana Pujari of Limbaguda got back 96 acres out of his 141

acres. On a strictly equalitarian basis he would have got only 40 acres.

These cases illustrate the changes wrought in the ownership pattern and the individual sacrifices made in the process of redistribution. Though the land is redistributed with full rights of cultivation, yet its ownership does not pass to the grantee, but rests in the village community. The individual farmer cannot sell or mortgage his holding and the village community has the right and is expected to exercise it, to have periodical reconsiderations and reallootments, say every five or ten years. The Orissa Bhoodan Act, as recently amended, recognises communal ownership of land in Gramdan villages. Its amended sec. 15-A lays down—

“Provided that where the land has been granted to a number of persons jointly or to the village community, all the persons to whom the land is granted or all the members of the village community, as the case may be, shall be jointly and severally liable for payment of the rent, cess or other dues payable to State Government in respect of the said land :

“Provided further when all the members of the village community are made liable for payment of rents, cess and other dues under the foregoing provision and they make such payment towards all such dues to the State Government in due time they shall be entitled to a rebate equal to ten per centum of the said payment.”

Collective Farms

A certain percentage of land is generally set apart for collective farming. The average for the 472 villages in Koraput comes to just over 3% of the total cultivated land. The actual amount varies from village to village. For instance, Akili in Ganjam, has 38 acres, 15% of its total land and Manpur in Cuttack has 35 acres (6%), while several villages have set apart none at all.

It may be asked, why no effort is being made to start collective farming, instead of redistributing the land? The answer is simply this, that the Indian peasant in Koraput or elsewhere is not amply equipped to handle the organisational and technical problems involved in collectivisation. So it was thought best to lay stress on equalitarian distribution, coupled with non-ownership and encourage villagers to experiment with collective or community farming on a small scale, to gather experience. Very few of the villages have as yet taken up their collective lands in right earnest, but a few results stand out. In Manpur they have been cultivating their collective lands on a share out basis since three years. The first year they got a net produce of 230 mds of paddy, which they credited to the village fund. The next year, there were heavy floods which ravaged the crops. This year they expect a good crop. In Akili starting only last year they jointly cultivated the collective land, every adult, and even children working in the fields according to his or her capacity. The grain produce was credited to the village fund while the potato crop and other vegetables were distributed to all the families on a per capita basis, without taking into consideration the amount of labour contributed by them. Thus, the aged and the disabled also got a fair deal.

Principles of Reconstruction

Vinobaji felt the need of making an early start with the reconstruction work so that the popular enthusiasm may be caught and channelised while at its highest peak. Accordingly the Sarva Seva Sangh has shouldered the task of guiding the reconstruction programme, helped by the Navajivan Mandal, a constructive organisation working mainly among the Adivasis in Orissa. Shri Annasaheb Sahasrabuddhe, Secretary of the Sangh is now at the helm of affairs, with his headquarters in Koraput.

Before going into the details of the activities we may do well to clarify some of the basic approaches underlying it.

Firstly it should be emphasised that the ultimate objective is not mere material well being, but an all round development of human personality. It aims at creating a society of free individuals, willingly and freely working together for the common weal. So the reconstruction work is to be carried out in such a way that the villagers should first feel the necessity for any project and resolve to shoulder such responsibility as they can and the Sangh will help them to carry out their resolve. They should feel that it is their own decisions that are being carried out, something is not being bestowed on them from above. The Sangh is to be there as a guide and a helper, not as an over riding authority. The measure of the success of the programme is not merely in the physical targets achieved or the amount of money spent, but in the degree in which it succeeds in drawing out the capacities of self-help, initiative, co-operation and responsibility in the people.

Keeping the above objects in view and taking into consideration the realities and resources, a broad order of priorities was decided upon in which the various items of development work were to be taken up. The first ones were (1) providing the landless who had now got land with bullocks and implements, (2) organisation of Co-operative Stores etc., (3) irrigation and (4) Khadi. The next to follow were, (1) education, (2) village industries, (3) sanitation and health etc. an effort was to be made to arouse the people in such a way that any one of the programmes taken up will get started on as wide a basis as possible over the whole area, thus giving it the shape of a popular movement. Thus, for instance; more than thirty Co-operative Stores were started within a short period of two months.

One of the fundamental principles of the Bhoodan movement is total social security, security for each and every individual in society. Gramadan lays the foundations for the construction of just such a social order in which the interests of all will be in harmony. So, after the abolition of conflicting interests in land, it is also

essential that new industries and sources of employment be developed in such a way that they donot create conflict of interests in the system, that one's employment does not encroach upon the means of livelihood of another.

The Sarvodaya idealists are not opposed to scientific technology as such and in fact Vinobaji has welcomed the harnessing of atomic energy as he hopes that it will help in decentralising the industries by providing an abundance of electrical power. They are also not wedded to such utterly austere standards of life as people imagine. They want to guarantee a minimum income of 3600 rupees per annum for every average family. But the Indian people are as yet very far from the ideal with 20% of its families earning less than 600 rupees per annum and another 31% managing with less than twelve hundred.

In Orissa the rural population is one of the poorest in India and perhaps Koraput is the poorest district. It has been estimated that the average income of a rural family in Koraput is somewhere in the region of 225 rupees per annum. The desperate need of the moment is to increase their real income at least three times in the shortest possible time to make life just bearable for them.

But when faced with the stark realities of the situation we find that modern conventional technology can be of very little help. The people are undernourished and have lost any skill of the fingers that they had. For them, technological progress has stopped centuries ago. For them we have to invent a new technology that will take into consideration the disused state of their hands and minds and slowly put skill back into them so that ultimately their awakened intellect takes over command. We are forced to realise that there is no other alternative but to adopt the technology of small tools developed by the Gandhian research workers.

[The Progress of Reconstruction

The Sarva Seva Sangh does not aspire to take up the responsibility for each and every village received in Gramdan. That responsibility rests ultimately with the people and the Govt. It has taken up the responsibility for the villages in Koraput, Ganjam, Balasore and Mayurbhanj districts only. The areas have been divided into seven blocks, five in Koraput and one each in Ganjam and the Balasore-Mayurbhanj areas. The areas are further subdivided into centres, each serving a group of 15-20 Gramdan villages. 45 such centres have been opened. Each centre is in charge of a worker who looks after all the developmental activities in the region. There are in all 120 workers including 45 lady-workers working under the programme. Budgets and plans have been drawn up and funds obtained from the Government of India, The Orissa Government, The Sarva Seva Sangh and the Gandhi Nidhi. An abstract of the budget proposals for the five years 1956-61 is given below.

1. Irrigation	18	Lakhs
2. Soil conservations	20	"
3. Bullock pairs	5	"
4. Housing	5	"
5. Training camps	4	"
6. Health	3	"
7. Demonstration Farms	10	"
8. Village Industries	10	"
9. Manufacture of agricultural tools, research and training	4.5	"
10. Preparation of reading material	0.15	"
11. Non-recurring capital expenditure	4.5	"
12. Stores	10.00	"

94.15 Lakhs.

But the actual progress of work has not been dictated by the cut and [dried schedules and estimates

of the budget, but has been moulded by the experiences gained from day to day and the objective realities of the situation as they were more and more clearly grasped.

Take for instance the problem of irrigation. The people are extremely water-conscious and almost every other village has a pet irrigation scheme of its own, which is often a good hunch. Proposals were first submitted for small projects to irrigate a total of 5000 acres in the first year. But it was soon apparent that it was hazardous to launch out on schemes without proper surveys and estimates. With the hands of the govt. departments full, enough surveyors or overseers were not available. So it was decided to open a training centre to train up a cadre of surveyors and engineers. The training classes have opened with twenty students who will do class room work and field work for alternating periods of about three months, so that actual construction work gets as early a start as possible. Then broad surveys of the countryside have revealed that soil conservation work is in same ways as important and urgent as irrigation schemes. So more emphasis will be laid henceforth on soil conservation and an effort made to make the villagers erosion-conscious.

Agricultural Improvement

The first programme taken up after the redistribution of land was distribution of bullocks to the former landless. 1091 pairs were distributed to 1593 families in 200 villages, this year. In many villages, to which bullocks could not be supplied, the villagers helped each other with the existing bullocks. As cow-keeping is very indifferently done in Koraput, there is an over all shortage of bullocks in the district. While it is planned to distribute a similar number of bullock-pairs this year also, steps are being taken to educate the people in good live-stock management and a cattle breeding centre has been opened.

A survey of the areas was jointly undertaken by the Director of Agriculture, Orissa, the Joint Director of Agriculture, Madhya Pradesh and the District Agriculture Officer, Koraput, and they have formulated proposals for a programme of agricultural development. According to this, six model agricultural farms will be started in the first instance, where improved methods will be first tried out under local conditions and then taught to trainees from the villages.

So far it has been possible to start only two such centres due to the lack of personnel. One plant nursery has also been started.

Agricultural implements worth a lakh of rupees donated by the Tata Steels has been distributed in the villages.

We have already touched on problems connected with irrigation and steps taken to meet them. Four Engineers have so far volunteered for service under the programme and taken charge of the construction and training schemes. A batch of engineering students from the Vallabh Vidyalaya in Gujrat volunteered their services last summer and carried out preliminary survey for irrigation schemes covering 3,000 acres. Work has been started on two small reservoir projects and two tanks. Work on the construction of 16 wells has also been begun. It is hoped to complete irrigation schemes covering 40,000 acres over five years.

It is to be noted that when part of the lands in a village is brought under irrigation the villagers agree to share the fields among all the families.

Fifteen students will be also trained in soil conservation who are expected to handle 10,000 acres annually.

Gramdan opens up unlimited possibilities for crop planning, soil conservation and land management in general but we will have to wait a while for concrete results in these directions.

Co-operative Stores

In order to put an end to exploitation by money-lenders and traders, that has incidentally reached unbelievable proportion in Koraput and Ganjam, and also to put the villagers in control of their economic activities, stores were started in the villages on a cooperative basis. The villagers contributed a minimum of rupee one and eight annas per family in shares etc and the Sarva Sava Sangh advanced upto ten times the capital thus collected. Forty seven stores have thus been opened. The total share capital collected exceeds Rs. 2500. The amount advanced by the Sangh so far is Rs. 14,447. The total turn-over by the end of May '56 exceeded Rs. 8000.

The stores will help to make the villagers conscious of their economic plight. Now for the first time they will have an idea of the exports and imports from their villages and will be prompted to control them. The stores will also serve as marketing centres for the surplus produce of the villages and extend credit facilities, thus developing into multi-purpose co-operative Societies. Steps are being taken to organise a central co-operative Union for the entire Gramdan area.

The village stores are not as yet formally registered as co-operative societies and money has been advanced to them on good faith. These are often managed by totally illiterate villagers, yet the management has been remarkably honest and efficient and the losses sustained so far have been insignificant.

Indebtedness

The extortions practiced by the money lenders, especially in Koraput and Ganjam, had been on an unbelievable scale. The unjust debts piled on the peasants are enormous and efforts are being made to scale them down through negotiations. It is a happy augury that some money lenders have agreed to scale down or

write off debts. Some have even let go lands they had held on mortgage for decades. But most of them are as yet hostile to Gramdan and have ceased extending loans to the villagers. Now the village stores are stepping into the breach by extending credit on bonded produce.

The only stable solution to the problem of indebtedness and insecurity is a village insurance scheme with annual premium contributions from every family that will cover cases of crop failure, accident, fire, sickness etc. These will be integrated into larger units that will be able to cover cases of major disaster affecting a whole village or a region. Vinoba has this in mind as one of the ultimate modes of utilisation of Sampattidan. The Sampattidan movement has also made good progress in the Koraput district, with a promised total annual contribution valued at Rs. 27400.

Villagers labouring on development projects are encouraged to save and pool a part of their earnings to build up a village fund. They are readily accepting the idea.

Khadi & Village Industries

The villagers are eager to take up spinning etc, but an early start could not be made due to the lack of accessories. A workshop for manufacturing charkhas and other accessories has been established at Rayaghada and is turning out about 300 charkhas monthly. 800 kisan charkhas have already been distributed in the villages and it is hoped that about 2000 of them will be distributed by the end of the financial year. cotton seeds have also been distributed.

It is proposed to encourage the villagers to take collective vows to have Khadi cloth only in their villages after, say, one year. Since more than a decade Khadi has taken root in some villages in the Koraput district. One who runs may see and marvel at the facility with which even teenagers have taken to the processes. It is immediately evident that the spinner

families are better clad than the rest. Khadi has helped them increase their standard. So it will not be difficult for the Khadi idea to spread.

Oil-pressing, pottery, soap-making, tanning and such other village industries will be gradually introduced and pilot schemes have already been started. These will be organised on a production for local consumption basis and only the surplus, if any, will be marketed.

Education

Though the problem of formal education has been shelved for a couple of years, yet in a real sense the whole scheme is one mighty educational effort. Through running their Grama Sabhas, managing their stores, working on engineering projects and in many other ways the people are learning things and their mental horizon is being widened as never before, because every scheme is based on the peoples understanding and co-operation. Youngmen from the villages will be also trained in agriculture, cattle-breeding, carpentry, smithy, pottery etc. at the various farms and centres and will carry on the activities in their own villages. It is proposed to even mobilise youngmen and women into labour corps to work on the various projects, living a disciplined life in camps and having a few hours of cultural and intellectual programmes. One such camp has been very successfully organised.

The urge for literacy is growing. Vinobaji laid great stress on it at every meeting in Koraput. Night schools for adults are being conducted by the workers. There are very few schools in the Koraput district. Literacy is only 5%. Education has to be provided for every child in every village and this will be according to the Basic system. A full fledged attack on the front will made only when the schemes that are to mitigate the desperate economic situation are well launched on their way. The immediate need is to ensure two square meals to everybody. Meanwhile efforts will be made to

get "one-hour schools" started in every village to provide the modicum of the three Rs to the children. Villagers undergoing the various vocational trainings will also be taught the three Rs, so that they can start the ferment in their villages and run these one-hour schools.

The Adivasis have their own languages. Kandha, Saura and Gadba are the important ones in Koraput. It is proposed to publish small booklets in these languages which will be useful for both children and adults. It is also necessary that the workers learn their languages to enter into their hearts. A manual in the Kandha language has been published while others are under preparation.

Research and Experiment

A laboratory has been set up with two trained scientists. They are engaged at present on researches on the utilisation of forest products and testing of materials used in engineering projects. The research facilities will have to be extended by stages to ultimately cover the needs of all the branches of activities. Ultimately it will be possible to integrate the whole structure, down from the basic schools up to the research institutes, into a full fledged rural university.

Health and Sanitation

The Adivasis have a surprising sense of neatness and beauty but are the victims of some insanitary personal habits mainly due to ignorance and poverty. Many do not even have enough clothing for a daily change, and wash. It will be easy enough to teach them better habits when they become a little better off.

Medical facilities in the areas are few and far between. Yaws is widely prevalent in the Ganjam-Koraput tract. Three doctors are at present employed on a campaign against yaws. Four sisters are working as injectors. They have treated and cured about 5,000

cases. Survey is being made as to the incidence of the disease in the area after which an intensive effort will be made with the help of volunteer doctors to eradicate the disease from the area within a short time.

All the lady-workers also help the villagers with advice, nursing and common medicines in cases of common ailments.

Prohibition

It is generally believed that it is impossible to make the Adivasi give up drink. But in point of fact thousands of them had given it up during the national movements. Vinobaji also laid great stress on it and the state Government agreed to enforce it in Koraput and Ganjam from April 1956. It was already in force in Balasore. In Koraput prohibition has had phenomenal success and all the government officials are agreed that there are very few cases of contravention. The reconstruction workers are also seeing to it that the villagers accept it whole heartedly. Liquor had been a very convenient tool in the hands of the exploiters and its eradication will liberate the people in more than one way.

Conclusion

This is in brief the outline of the Gramdan movement and the subsequent reconstruction activities in Orissa. We are afraid we have done scant justice to it in this small compass. We would have liked to touch on the numerous little day to day incidents that give us glimpses of the inner working of the peoples mind ; the collective marriage ceremonies that cut down cost and ward off the money lender, the habitual criminal who was given land on trust and was reformed, the store with the unlocked doors and so on and on. But we must stop.

An appeal

It is as yet too early to foresee the fargoin changes that the movement will bring about in the

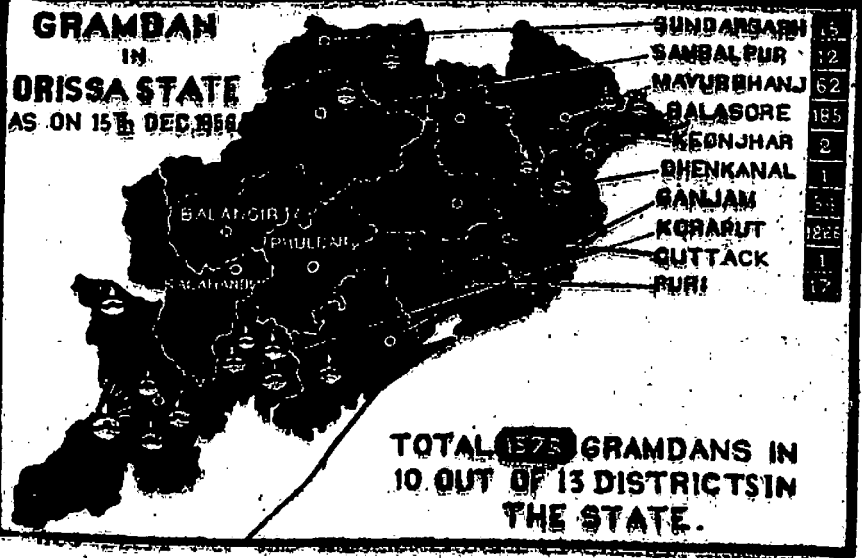
social fabric of the country, but this much is certain, it has caught the imagination of the masses and may one day attain undreamt of proportions. Even as it stands today, it is one of the most exciting adventures of the century, a tremendous opportunity to build society anew from the grass roots. It is up to our countrymen to seize it. The villagers have pooled what ever resources they had, now it behoves us to add our contributions to it. They need the help of economists, engineers, doctors, educationists, agronomists and businessmen, in short, of every one gifted with a talent.

They can help even by criticising. It is too difficult for the workers who are instrumental in creating a movement to study it dispassionately and objectively, however earnestly they may try. But scientific minds standing outside the fray can study it with detachment and by warning against the pitfalls and errors and confirming the correct moves can render invaluable help. This booklet will have served its purpose if it succeeds in arousing such active curiosity in even a few minds.

Statistics concerning land redistribution in the Grandan Villages in Orissa.

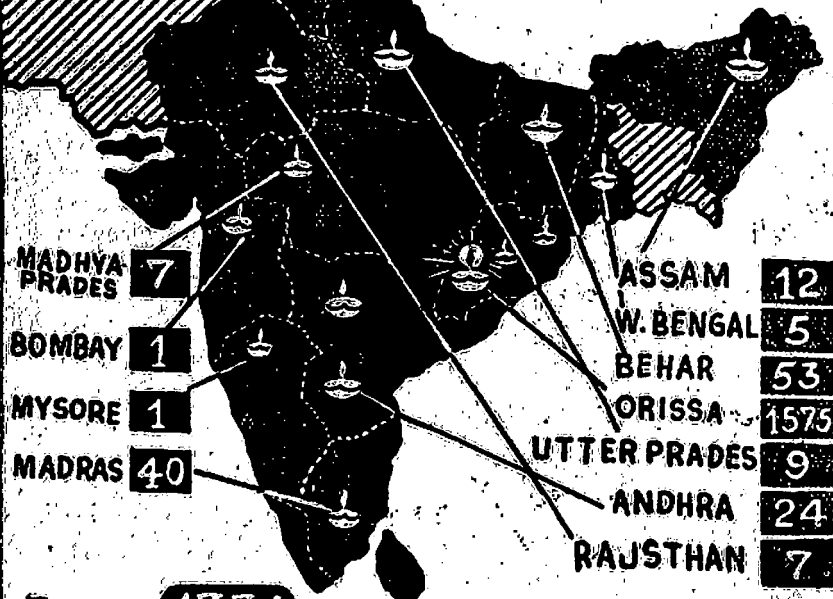
District.	No. of villages redistributed.	Total No. of families.	Total population.	No. of landless families.	Landless population.	Total land distributed (acres)	Land kept for community farming.	Undistributed land.
Koraput.	472	9598	56929	2690	11,506	53787	1731	29000
Outtack.	1	119	631	6	17	537	37	...
Balasore.	93	1738	...	162	...	3782	...	...
Mayurbhanj.	9	223	...	13	...	494	...	...
Ganjam.	21	886	...	...	...	1255	...	...

GRAMDAN IN ORISSA STATE AS ON 15 DEC 1964



GRAMDAN IN INDIA

AS ON 15th. Dec. 1956



TOTAL 1734 GRAMDANS IN 11 OUT OF 14 STATES IN THE COUNTRY